

Communicating Up

Building Confidence Across Generations

New Intern Onboarding Workshop
NorthStar Rail

Communication Challenge Lab



Communication Reality Check

What makes “communicating up” feel hard for new interns?

**You know the work.
Now make your message easy to act on.**

How formal should I be?

Will my question sound obvious?

How much detail is enough?

What if I get feedback?

Today is not a lecture.

It is a lab for testing better communication choices.



Choose



Rewrite



Practice



Commit

By the end, you will be able to...

Six practical outcomes for your first 30 days.

- 1 Read the manager lens: what leaders need from you**
- 2 Adapt tone by audience and channel**
- 3 Use CLEAR for updates, requests, and questions**
- 4 Ask specific questions without over-apologizing**
- 5 Respond to feedback with ownership**
- 6 Create a 30-day communication commitment**

90-Minute Challenge Map

Each section includes a quick action, not just listening.

